

Usability Test Report: Hey, Neighbor!

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Team G

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The purpose of our usability test was to understand how intended users, Calvin students, interact with the Hey, Neighbor! app and to identify areas where navigation, clarity, or functionality could be improved before the final release. Across five test sessions, users completed core tasks such as signing up, logging in, browsing items, searching, bookmarking, listing items, and editing posted items. They used the thinking-aloud protocol, which allowed us to gather immediate, authentic reactions to the interface and workflow.

Below are the key findings from our users, along with our team's plan to address each concern:

- Users found that the “Return Home” button after sending a borrow request brought them back to the login/sign-up screen, making it seem like they were logged out.
 - The developers will fix the navigation so it returns users to the home borrowing page instead of the login screen.
- Users reported that search results didn't display items accurately and often felt they needed to clear recent searches to better see the items listed on the home screen. Overall, they did not like the recent searches feature.
 - The developers will remove the recent searches section from the home screen search-bar.
- When uploading item images, a user found that zoomed-in photos did not frame correctly when uploaded.
 - The developers will improve image scaling.
- Several users found that editing or deleting listed items did not work and item descriptions could not be edited nor shown.
 - The developers will repair the editing and deleting functionality and allow full editing of item descriptions.
- Users couldn't bookmark items from within the item-details page, and the back arrow on the bookmarks screen wasn't working.
 - The developers will add a bookmark icon to item pages and fix the back navigation in the bookmarks tab.
- One user noted confusion from the white top bar blending in with the iPhone time, battery, etc.
 - The developers will adjust the top color scheme for better contrast with phone font color.
- A user saw ratings displayed but could not rate or view rating details.
 - The developers will either complete the ratings feature or remove it.

Across all five tests, users consistently described the app as visually appealing, simple to use, and something they would genuinely use—especially for textbooks, tools, and school supplies. The Browse tab and onboarding welcome screens received particularly positive feedback. Most issues centered on navigation to homescreen, editing/deleting items, and image uploading and listing workflow. These findings give us a clear roadmap for refinement before the final release.